

6.1 Operating Systems

6.1.1 AIX

Advanced Interactive Executive, an operating system developed by IBM, which is based on the UNIX operating system. It is typically used by larger enterprises, financial institutions, banks, etc. where there is a critical need for robust security features and mission-critical sturdiness. However, over the years, both Windows and Linux have narrowed this gap considerably.

6.1.2 Linux

Born out of a geek's inability to gain access to a freeware version of UNIX, the Linux operating system, developed by Linus Torvalds, is among the most popular operating systems after Windows. Based loosely on UNIX, Linux is an



Linux as it is today

open source operating system. For those of you who are scandalised by the prices that Microsoft charges for its licenses, a free operating system like Linux may just be the ticket. While it may lack the glamour, razzle-dazzle, and spit and polish of Windows, it is a highly stable system that can do most computing tasks that you do in Windows without your being any the worse for it. There are many applications available for Linux, including replacements for Microsoft Office in the form of OpenOffice.

6.1.3 Mac OS

The Macintosh operating system from Apple Computer has been around since 1984, and was the first operating system to introduce the graphical user interface (GUI). Since then, it has been overtaken by Windows, even though Mac users are quick to defend it and say that the Mac OS is superior to Windows in



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